# Dose-dense AC → weekly paclitaxel + 3-weekly trastuzumab

Four AC cycles 14 days apart, followed by paclitaxel weekly for 12 doses and IV trastuzumab every 21 days. Trastuzumab then continues to complete one year total.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

## A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

### 1 Heart

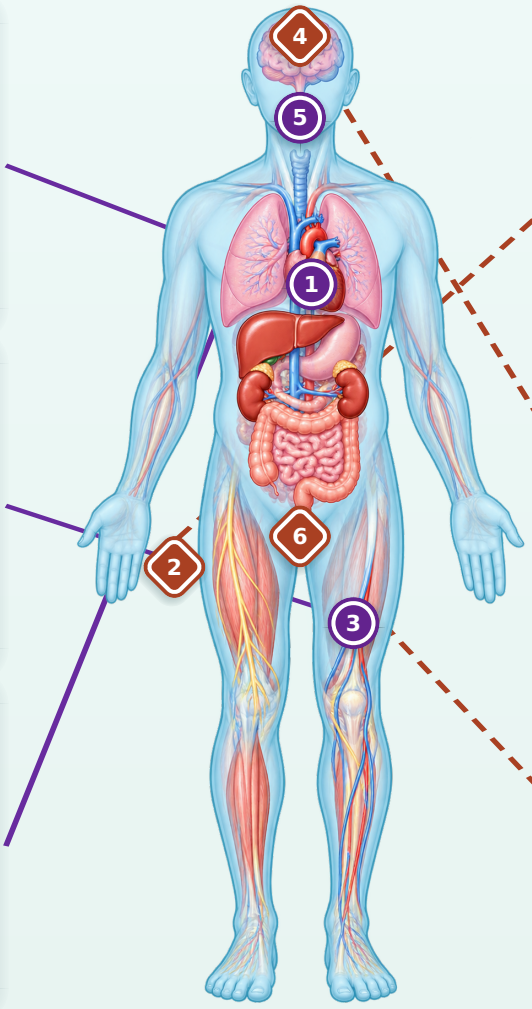
**Doxorubicin / trastuzumab**

Baseline assessment; report chest pain, breathlessness or swelling.

### 2 Hands / feet

**Paclitaxel**

Report numbness or tingling before the next dose.




### 3 Blood / infection

**Chemotherapy phase**

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: call immediately.

### 4 Hair / scalp

**Chemotherapy phase**

Hair loss is common. Ask about scalp cooling before treatment where suitable.

### 5 Mouth

**Chemotherapy phase**

Painful ulcers or difficulty drinking need advice.

### 6 Bladder

**Cyclophosphamide**

Report blood in urine or painful urination.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Markers refer to the named active medicines. During HER2-only continuation, chemotherapy effects are not new expected effects of the antibodies; lingering chemotherapy effects still need review.

> Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

NCCP 00745 · PRACTICAL SUPPORT

# Your treatment, at home.

## Important medicine-specific effects

### Doxorubicin

- Low counts, infection and mouth ulcers
- Nausea, hair loss and fatigue
- Heart damage, sometimes delayed
- Severe tissue injury if the infusion leaks
- Rare later blood cancers

### Cyclophosphamide

- Low counts and infection
- Nausea, vomiting and hair loss
- Bladder irritation / bleeding
- Fertility effects and menopause
- Rare later blood cancers

### Paclitaxel

- Low blood counts and infection
- Numbness / tingling, sometimes lasting
- Hair loss, muscle or joint pain
- Infusion reaction
- Mouth, bowel, skin and nail effects

### Trastuzumab

- Heart pumping-function reduction / heart failure
- Infusion or allergic reaction
- Diarrhoea and fatigue
- Rare serious lung effects

**Surgery, radiation and monitoring:** open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

## Make the plan practical

### The correct phase prescription

AC is high emetogenic risk; a separate low-risk taxane script replaces it.

### Premedicines and growth factors

Paclitaxel premedicines differ between weekly and fortnightly dosing. Use the phase-specific prescription.

### Tests and appointments

The team should name the booking owner, due window and person reviewing each required test. Tell them if an expected appointment has not arrived.

### After chemotherapy

HER2-only continuation has its own minimal-emetic-risk plan; do not automatically continue chemotherapy steroids, antiemetics or growth factors.

**Emergency: 112 / 999.** Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

**Contact oncology immediately** for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

CUH · MON–FRI 8AM–5PM

**087 181 9645**

Acute Oncology Service

CUH · WEEKENDS / BANK HOLIDAYS 9AM–5PM

**021 4922000**

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

**Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED**

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

**Complete reference, visual timeline and passport**

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00745/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.